League. It was never implemented. The League was impaired from the beginning due to the abstention of the superpowers like the United States to join it and also due to mutual rivalries among the member states, each zealously guarding its national interest. The League failed to take effective measures either during the Manchurian crisis or against the acts of aggression by Nazi Germany, culminating in the attack of Poland. It was only during the Italo–Ethiopian crisis that the League, for once, made extensive effort to implement the collective security provisions. As Claude observed, “The league experience might be summarized as an abortive attempt to translate the collective security idea into a working system. The failure of collective security in this period was not so much the failure of the system to operate successfully as its failure to be established”.[23]

The Charter of the United Nations contains provisions relating to collective security. Article I of the Charter stating the purposes and principles of the UN, aims at maintaining international peace and security as its top priority and, to that end declares to take effective collective measures for the prevention and removal of threats to peace. Chapter VII of the Charter with regard to *Action with respect to Threats to the Peace, Breaches of the Peace, and Acts of Aggression* contains provisions from Articles 39–51 relating to the collective security system. The Charter invests supreme power on the Security Council to initiate collective security action in cases of breach of international peace of security. The United Nations evoked the collective security measures during the Korean crisis of 1950. Another test of the collective security system came during the Congo crisis of 1960. The more current operation includes the one during Iraq’s invasion of Kuwait in 1991. But it was more so on the insistence and preponderance of the United States that the collective actions were taken. The 2003 invasion of Iraq by the United States on the plea of eliminating weapons of mass destruction, and USA’s War on Terror against Afghanistan, were unilateral decisions and the United Nations was bypassed in these cases of intervention. This has undermined the credibility of collective action measures under the auspices of the United Nations. Further, during the heydays of Cold War, the superpower relations affected the operation of Security